

Hands-On Lab: Setting up AWS KMS Key for S3 Encryption

Objective

In this lab, you will create a customer-managed AWS KMS key and configure an Amazon S3 bucket to use this key for server-side encryption (SSE-KMS).

Prerequisites

- AWS Account with administrator or KMS/S3 permissions
- Access to AWS Management Console
- Basic understanding of AWS IAM, S3, and KMS

Lab Architecture Overview

Amazon S3 bucket encrypted using a customer-managed AWS KMS symmetric key.

Step 1: Create a Customer Managed KMS Key

1. Sign in to the AWS Management Console.
2. Navigate to Services → Security, Identity & Compliance → KMS.
3. Click Create key.
4. Select Symmetric as key type and Encrypt and decrypt for key usage.
5. Click Next.
6. Enter Alias (example: alias/s3-encryption-key).
7. (Optional) Add a description and tags.
8. Click Next.
9. Select key administrators (e.g., your IAM user or role).
10. Click Next.
11. Select key users (IAM roles/users or the S3 service if required).
12. Click Finish.

Step 2: Create an S3 Bucket

1. Navigate to Services → Storage → S3.
2. Click Create bucket.
3. Enter a globally unique bucket name.
4. Choose an AWS region (same region as KMS key).
5. Leave other settings default or as per organizational policy.
6. Click Create bucket.

Step 3: Enable Default Encryption Using KMS

1. Open the created S3 bucket.
2. Go to Properties tab.
3. Scroll to Default encryption and click Edit.
4. Choose Enable.
5. Select Server-side encryption with AWS KMS keys (SSE-KMS).

6. Choose Select from your AWS KMS keys.
7. Select the key alias created earlier.
8. Click Save changes.

Step 4: Upload and Validate Encryption

1. Upload a file to the S3 bucket.
2. Select the uploaded object.
3. Go to the Properties tab.
4. Verify the Server-side encryption shows AWS-KMS.

Step 5: Optional CLI Validation

`aws s3api head-object --bucket <bucket-name> --key <object-name>`

Verify SSEKMSKeyId in the response.

Cleanup

1. Delete objects in the S3 bucket.
2. Delete the S3 bucket.
3. Schedule deletion of the KMS key.

Outcome

You have successfully configured S3 default encryption using a customer-managed AWS KMS key.